

GAURAV GANDHI

Chicago, IL

| gauravshikhargandhi@gmail.com**EXPERIENCE**

2026	GENER8TOR (<i>nationally ranked accelerator network</i>) Investment Accelerator Associate - Designed and led stakeholder design thinking workshop, building a strategic proposal evolving the operating model from episodic program into continuous platform, scaling contract value from \$8.7M to up to \$19.2M. - Built a free, self-updating funding database pulling water-tech grants, RFPs and prizes from 15+ public sources - Drove cohort operations for Great Lakes Innovation Accelerator, a \$13.4M program providing \$100k in non-dilutive funding to 5 water-tech startups through 1:1 mentorship, investor connections, and founder trainings	Chicago, IL
2025	KEARNEY, PRODUCT EXCELLENCE RENEWAL LAB (<i>Hardware & Engineering Practice</i>) Summer Associate, PERLab - Built the stage-gate toolkit for a client's 2-year heavy industrial NPI process implementing a 7-level engineering systems model, standardizing platforms to speed proposal planning across 13+ product lines (6 platforms) - Identified \$15M+ in savings and a prioritized roadmap by analyzing 5 years of manufacturing change-order data (~5,000 records), clustering root causes by type and department to show 85% traced to high-impact fixes - Built a skills matrix from a 500-person, 90-question survey mapped across 6 departments, benchmarking present vs. needed skills against job descriptions to flag cross-functional competency gaps and inform upskilling	Chicago, IL
2024	RACE ENERGY (<i>pre-series A (~\$15M valuation) electric vehicle start up</i>) Strategy Development at Founder's Office - Uncovered ~\$30K in savings through financial modeling, roughly 1% of the company's valuation at the time - Ran market, competitor, and regulatory analysis across 7 states to build a 2-to-7-state expansion strategy	Hyderabad, India
2018 - 2023	MICHELIN (<i>2nd largest tire manufacturer, \$23B market cap</i>) Concept Product Design Analyst - Developed and tested Michelin LCA tool contributing to a 30% cut in Scope 1 & 2 emissions and 30% rise in sustainable-material rate; owned go/no-go decisions for 2 APAC B2B products against decarbonization targets - Cut prototype model development lead times by 80% by building and shipping an internal decision support design tool and framework adopted by 12 engineers across ~50 products annually - Owned end-to-end development of 2 B2B products from concept to launch; ran structured experimentation and validation, improving 10–30% across multiple performance metrics (rolling resistance, mileage, wear) - Built an Analytical Performance Guide for a future tech to replace day-long simulations with analytical factors, letting engineers compare technology tradeoffs and performance in real time during design events Product Development and Industrialization Engineer - Owned launch execution and product quality for 2 B2B portfolios across 3 APAC plants, driving 10+ product lines from prototype to volume production (100K units/year) to deliver \$50M in annual revenue - Drove first-pass yield ('Right First Time') to a record 95%+, up from 80%, by rebuilding and deploying 2 internal digital automation tools adopted by 100+ engineers across 5 teams - Cut prototype-to-mass-production time 75% (2 years → 6 months) on a 4-product-line transfer from China to Thailand by aligning product development and manufacturing on shared KPIs and one integrated launch plan	Shenyang, China & Pune, India 2022 - 2023 2018 - 2021

EDUCATION

2024 - 2026	KELLOGG SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT MCCORMICK SCHOOL OF ENGINEERING NORTHWESTERN UNIVERSITY GMAT: 760 <i>MMM Dual Degree: MBA and MS Design Innovation; (Dean's List, Major: Operations)</i> Capstone: Led end-to-end human-centered discovery and PoC development of 4 AI-powered features for a B2B banking platform; validated 4.6/5 adoption intent across 20+ user-research interviews with finance leaders Kellogg RAG: Built a production RAG with neural reranking, conversational memory over 375+ documents Winner, Kellogg Design Challenge: Won the world's largest MBA design competition with 80+ participants Abrams Climate Fellow: Selected as one of 30 graduate fellows across 6 graduate schools at Northwestern, led team of four to build climate-tech investment thesis through 20+ expert interviews (VCs, Founders, LPs)	Evanston, IL
2014 - 2018	BIRLA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY & SCIENCE, PILANI <i>B.E. (Hons.) Mechanical Engineering</i> Winner, Reverse Engineering, Head of Fundraising & Aero, Formula Student Team: Raised 40% of team budget	Pilani, India

ADDITIONAL DATA

- Skills and tools:** Lean Six Sigma, Lean Manufacturing, Process Improvement, Process Documentation, DOE, FMEA, Root Cause Analysis, SPC, DFM/DFA, New Product Introduction (NPI), Product Lifecycle Management (PLM), Product Roadmapping, Change Management, Generative AI, Advanced Excel, Power BI, Python, CAD
- Community & Interests:** ultramarathon (x2), IRONMAN 70.3mi, chocolate chip cookie connoisseur